

Kameleon 8 URC 8308

Mammoth All In One

People owning different electronic appliances such as TVs and set top boxes know there's an additional burden of running around for different remotes to control each one of them. The Kameleon 8 URC 8303 is an all-in-one remote to take away all the hassles.

The device is sturdy and built well with its aluminium body, but it's also is very large—to the point where it's a little difficult to hold in your hand. The most attractive feature other than being able to control the devices through a single device is the touchpad, with an attractive display.

Setting up the remote for the devices is extremely simple and most of the buttons and menus automatically show up on the remote. The remote can also be set up to learn from other remotes. Every time the device in use is changed, the display also changes the icons for them accordingly. The remote's use isn't limited to just TVs and set top boxes—it can even be used to control the lighting of your room.

Other than the touchpad buttons, there are also hard physical buttons for changing channels and adjusting volume levels. Unfortunately, these

are really tiny and awkward in a remote of this size. The remote runs off three AAA batteries.

There aren't a lot of companies that sell all-in-one remotes in India. The price of the URC 8308 Kameleon 8 is Rs 4,995 in the market, which might make it seem a bit expensive. However, it's worth every single penny if you own many remote controlled devices. The other alternative for this kind of remote are priced at much higher rates. If you ignore the size of the remote, then it's a really classy looking product for your home.

Contact: One For All
Phone: +91-80-40351800
E-mail: ajit@uebv.com
Web site: www.oneforall.co.in
Price: Rs 4,995



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

MSI X48C Platinum

DDR2 And DDR3!

Intel has recently unleashed out many new chipsets into the market and the X48 is one of the latest. MSI has released a board based on this chipset—the MSI X48C Platinum. The board supports ATI's CrossfireX through two PCI-E 2.0 x16 slots.

The design is spruced up with copper fins and heat sinks. The feature that makes the X48C special is that the board supports both DDR 2 and DDR 3

RAM. There are two slots for DDR2 and four for DDR3, which allow for a maximum of 4 and 8 GB of RAM respectively. Both the RAM modules will not operate together and a separate memory turbo cards are provided to place in the unused slots.

The layout is clean overall, but there are no clips to lock cards in place. The SATA ports are placed out

the way of the PCI-E slots. Realtek's ALC 888 is used as the audio solution for the motherboard, and it also has Realtek's 8111B Gigabit networking solution. At the rear end, there is no shortage of connectivity options. There are eight USB ports and also two PS2 ports for the keyboard and mouse, which had become a rarity on some of the newer boards.

The board performed flawlessly in the tests. Once again, there is little performance improvement over the other chipsets and manufacturers. It lags a little behind than the nForce 790i motherboards in some of the synthetic memory benchmarks.

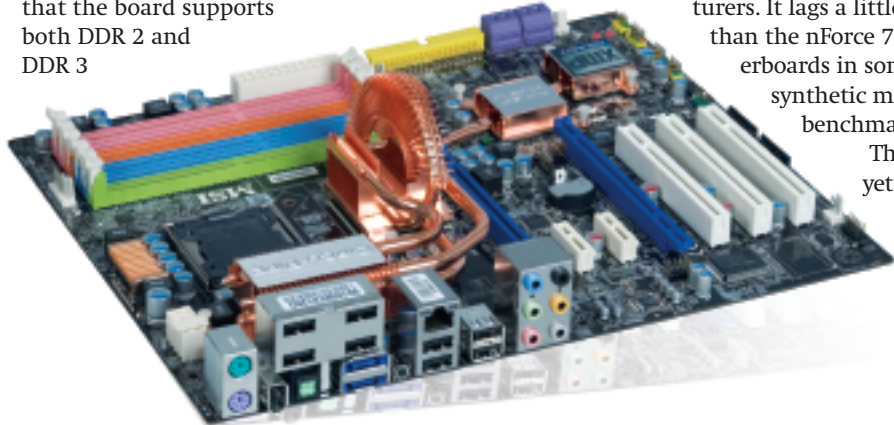
The X48 is yet another

upgrade from the previous X38 platform and brings nothing special to the table other than a few minor upgrades. At Rs 15,500, it isn't mainstream material either. It will, however, interest users who want to go to DDR3 when they get cheaper—but as of now, they're happy with DDR2.

Specifications
LGA775, Supports FSB up to 1600MHz, ICH9R Southbridge, Supports up to DDR3 1600 and DDR2 800, ATI CrossFire supported.

Contact: MSI
Phone: +91-11-41758808 / 09
E-mail: marketing@msi-india.com
Web site: www.msi-india.com
Price: Rs 15,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



Kingston DataTraveler 400

Good Performer And Secure!

Kingston's DataTraveler 400 is a product focussing on the mobile office-goer. Security is one part of the concern and the other being able to carry data regularly and synchronising it with their home PC. We have the 2GB version of the DataTraveler 400 here with us.

The design is sturdy and the drive opens up on an axis from its protection layer. The DT 400 isn't just about looks. A thorough run through the benchmarks reveals it is also quite the performer. In the sequential file transfer tests, we were able to write 100 MB files to the drive in 8 seconds and read off it in 3.6 seconds.



SiSoft Sandra recorded read speeds of 33 MBps. Random access times were also very low at 0.4 seconds. Burst speeds of 35 MBps were also recorded in HDtch.

There are additional features for security in the drive. As with other manufacturers, there's a utility, which allows you to create a secure partition. An addi-

tional utility called Migo Sync is also bundled on the drive. It allows you to select folders on the computers and sync data between multiple PCs. It isn't just files and folders that are synchronised—it's also data from mail clients and browsers. The application itself is actually quite extensive in features.

The 2 GB DataTraveler 400 is priced at Rs 2,255. In comparison, standard 2 GB flash drives are available at giveaway prices of around Rs 500. It's difficult to justify this kind of price for 2 GB drives, even though it's a well performing flash drive.

Specifications
Capacity: 2 GB, Dimensions: 70 x 22.4 x 11.3 mm

Contact: Kingston Technology
E-mail: sales_india@kingston.com
Web site: www.kingston.com
Price: Rs 2,255

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Thermalright Ultima 90i

Intel On Ice

One of the things both Intel's 65-nm and 45-nm parts have in common is their over clocking potential, and as any Core 2 Duo user will tell you, simply buy a slower processor and overclock it to faster speeds. But you don't want to be over clocking uncontrollably, as even Intel's excellent thermal thresholds are easily crossed once the FSBs and multipliers are tweaked.

Thermalright is a known vendor of high performance CPU and GPU aftermarket coolers. Their latest CPU cooler—the Ultra 120 Extreme—is a massive tower-like cooling solution fea-

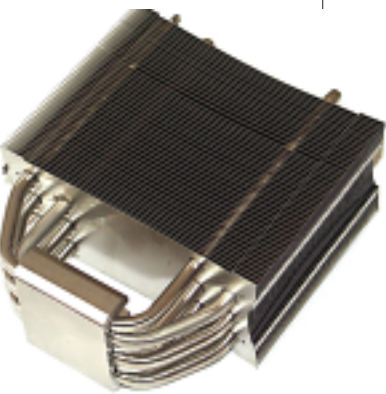
turing six heat pipes. This monster needs to be paired with an equally space hogging 120-mm fan to perform at its best. Many users' cabinets also aren't wide enough to accommodate the high Ultra 120 Extreme, so Thermalright's design engineers came out with the Ultima 90i. It's much smaller and weighs just 460 grams—much lighter than the Ultra 120's 790 grams. This cooler is best used with a 92-mm fan. It looks like a shrunk down Ultra 120, and retains the same six heat pipes.

To install this heat sink, you'll need to remove your motherboard. This involves the installation of a back

plate on the rear of the motherboard. Though tedious, this is the best way to secure a CPU cooler.

We used this heat sink with two processors—a hotter, and older Core 2 Duo Extreme X6800 (2.93 GHz), and a newer Core 2 Quad Extreme QX9650 (3 GHz).

A difference of 24 degrees on an over clocked quad core just says it all. Even the older X6800 runs 22 degrees cooler at a clock of 3.5 GHz. Very impressive for a cooler which weighs the same as Intel's stock cooler. There are two issues we see with users swapping out their stock Intel coolers and plonking this on—the tedious installation, and the absence of a fan with stock package. A good 92-mm fan



from the likes of Panaflo or NMB will set you back by a cool Rs 600, which should be added to the price of the cooler. At Rs 2,500 for the Ultima 90i, you're looking at around Rs 3,000 for the entire setup. Good for overclockers, others give it a skip.

Specifications
Six heat pipe-based cooling solution, weight—460 gm, dimensions—115 x 55 x 139 mm

Contact: Tirupati Enterprises
Phone: 9339207519
E-mail: mail@tirupati.net
Website: www.thermalright.com
Price: Rs 2,900

Scores			
Processor	Core Speed (Stock Cooling)	Temperature (Ultima 90i)	Temperature
Core 2 Duo X6800	2.93 GHz	61 deg	47 deg
Core 2 Duo X6800	3.5 GHz	71 deg	49 deg
Core 2 Quad QX9650	3.00 GHz	66 deg	48 deg
Core 2 Quad QX9650	3.81 GHz	75 deg	51 deg

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★